

## **POLI 209: Analyzing Public Opinion**

Summer Session II

M/Tu/W/Th/F

1:15pm-2:45pm

112 Murphey Hall

**Graduate Instructor:** Allen Wilson

**Email:** awils@unc.edu

**Office Hours:** M/W/F, 12:00pm-1:00pm; Tu/Th, 11:00am-12:00pm; or by appointment

**Office Hours Location:** Hamilton (Pauli Murray) Hall 323 or via Zoom

### **Course Description and Objectives**

This course has four primary objectives. Our first objective is to gain an understanding of how political preferences are formed. Individuals' political preferences are held with differing levels of conviction, are acquired from different sources, and do not tend to conform rationally or logically to a strict ideological structure. Understanding what underlies the political preferences of the mass public holds and how these preferences are formed is critical to any analysis of public opinion.

The second objective of this course is to develop the tools to analyze public opinion. Survey research is only as good as the measurement tools employed to capture the public's attitudes. For example, the way questions are worded and framed can have large substantive impacts on our results. Still more errors can occur if those answering our survey are not representative of the population we are seeking to study. How might we design and field our surveys in a way that provides us with accurate information as to what the American public is thinking?

Our third objective largely consists of marrying the first two objectives together in order to become better analysts of public opinion. In recent election cycles, the ubiquity of polling has been overwhelming. Even in non-election cycles, as we are in now, much is made of public opinion on many different issues. Any firm or entity with a few thousand dollars to spare can generate a survey with a reasonable sample size (~1000 respondents) these days. Politicians and pundits enjoy using data points from these surveys to serve their own interests, yet so often their pronouncements are a product of over-generalizing results or poor analysis of the underlying survey methodology itself, as well as a general misunderstanding of the nature of public opinion.

By the end of this class, it is my goal that we all will be better consumers and analysts of survey research and, hopefully, will be able to share this information with others as well.

The final objective is to be able to undertake public opinion research independently. This includes forming a hypothesis, operationalizing variables into survey questions, using statistical methods to test a hypothesis, and reaching a substantive conclusion. Class sessions, readings, and assignments will assist in shoring up these skills. Ultimately, this will culminate in your final project, which is your opportunity to show that you can bring together the tools and skills you have developed in the course to conduct survey research. It is my goal that by the end of the semester, everyone in the class will be able to understand, analyze, critique, and conduct survey research.

### **Office Hours and Communicating with Me**

I will be available for office hours every day, from 12pm-1pm on M/W/F and 11am-12pm on Tu/Th, in 323 Hamilton (Pauli Murray) Hall. Please stop by if you have any questions or concerns about the course, especially regarding the statistical assignments and the final project. If you can't make it during that time, please send me an email, and we will schedule a Zoom meeting or a separate appointment. I am usually around in the mornings on weekdays, but after class ends each day, I have to go home and take my dog outside for a walk. So, afternoon meetings will typically need to be held via Zoom.

Please reach out to me via email ([awils@unc.edu](mailto:awils@unc.edu)) at any time if you have a question about the course or assignments. The rapid pace of the course necessitates quick response times from me. In a normal semester, I commit to responding within 24-48 hours. For this course, I will respond within 24 hours, with some grace for the weekends. If I have not responded to your email within 24 hours, please send me a follow-up email. Sometimes emails get lost in my draft folder. If you have a question about an assignment, I ask that you give me 24 hours to respond. Late night emails will most likely not be answered until the following morning.

### **Required Software**

In this course, you will learn to use two programs: **R** and Qualtrics. **R** is open-source and free to all users. It is quite popular for this reason, and it also allows users to conduct statistical analyses and generate graphics based on raw data. Familiarity with this program will help as you continue to in political science courses at UNC, and it ought to be helpful on the job market as well!

Qualtrics is an online survey tool that allows us to build surveys customized to our specific surveys and research questions. Qualtrics is also free to all UNC faculty and students (with your tuition dollars, of course). Instructions for downloading each appear below.

I understand that there will be unequal levels of experience with **R** and Qualtrics in the class. Rest assured, we will begin from square one with both programs. The labs and assignments are built to help you develop the skills to use these tools effectively for the final project and to lay a foundation upon which you can build future skills. I will be available every day for office hours if you ever require additional assistance.

### **Downloading and Installing Software**

1. To download and install **R** Statistical Software.
  - Go to the following link: <http://cran.us.r-project.org/>
  - Select “Download **R** for Windows” or “Download **R** for macOS” depending on your computer.
    - For Windows/PC
      - Click “Install **R** for the first time”
      - Download **R** Windows; this will download an .exe file.
      - Open the .exe file and follow instructions for installation using the default settings
    - For macOS
      - Follow the instructions in this video:  
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I5WIMX4LK8M>
2. RStudio. Download the “RStudio Desktop” version at: <https://posit.co/downloads/>
3. Qualtrics Research Suite. Go to the following link, which has information on Qualtrics: <https://tdx.unc.edu/TDClient/33/Portal/Requests/ServiceDet?ID=75>.
  - Click the link “here” under the subheading “Creating an Account”.
  - Input your UNC Onyen and password to create an account.

### **Required Texts**

You are not required to purchase a textbook for this class. I will post the relevant sections of the textbook to Canvas. We will use the textbook below, which is available online via UNC libraries here: <https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/unc/detail.action?docID=1757959>.

- Rea, Louis M., and Richard A. Parker. 2014. *Designing and Conducting Survey Research: A Comprehensive Guide*. Fourth edition. San Francisco, CA: John Wiley & Sons.

## **Grading Policy**

I am sure you have heard and read these words many times, but grades do not define you. In many cases, grades do not matter. Only in certain circumstance will grades heavily affect your future career prospects. I am happy to talk at any time about my own experiences and give advice about grades, if it is solicited.

Having done a throat-clearing on that point, it is my hope to give everyone in this class an “A.” Some courses and academic programs are *marathons*; this class, however, is closer to a *sprint* due to time constraints and the scope of the course. That means that you may opt to aim for a “B” or “C.” That is perfectly fine and is up to your discretion, and I will not hold this against you. If you ever have any questions about assignments, readings, or the final project, I will be available every day for office hours from 12pm–1pm, and I will be available via Zoom and email as well. The grade distribution for assignments appears below as well as the grading scale.

- 10%: Attendance/Engagement
- 20%: Quizzes (4 in total, 5 percentage points each)
- 20%: Coding assignments (5 in total, 4 percentage points each)
- 10%: Qualtrics assignments (2 in total, 5 percentage points each)
- 5%: Research proposal and survey questions
- 25%: Final paper
- 10%: Final presentation

A 93-100, A- 90-92, B+ 87-89, B 83-86, B- 80-82, C+ 77-79, C 73-76, C- 70-72, D+ 67-69, D 63-66, D- 60-62, F 59 and below.

## **Attendance and Engagement**

As mentioned above, this class is more like a sprint than a marathon. That means that active attendance and engagement are required for this course. We will meet only a handful of times of the course of five weeks. If you do not attend class regularly, it is very likely that you will fall

behind. If you are not prepared for class (e.g., having done the readings), are distracted (e.g., by social media), or generally not paying attention, success in the class will be difficult. Minor infractions may be given grace, but repeatedly missing class or being disengaged is more difficult to overlook.

Attendance and engagement, then, makes up 10% of your grade as an incentive. I would strongly prefer that you **not miss more than 2 class sessions** (excluding workshop days). However, I am flexible, given extenuating circumstances. If you must miss more than 2 class sessions, please communicate this in writing for approval. The primary reason for this is that you might fall behind with too many absences, and we will need to meet individually to make sure steady progress is maintained.

Engagement is broadly defined. Nearly every day of class is accompanied by a required reading or two, which will be highly relevant to class. We will discuss in class how to read an academic article efficiently. **The quality of the class depends on your willingness to read these materials before each class and preparation to discuss them.** Please do not engage with social media, text others, shop online, etc., in class. Laptops are absolutely fine to use in class if you would like, but I reserve the right to change this policy if there is too much disengagement.

### **Quizzes**

To incentivize daily participation and reading, I have included semi-weekly quizzes. There will be 4 quizzes in total, each worth 5% of your total grade. These are designed to gauge your general engagement with the course material. There will be no trick questions. Regular attendance and engagement should ensure a high grade on quizzes.

### **Coding Assignments**

I will assign 5 assignments in **R** to help facilitate the development of the tools needed to carry out the final project. **Please read the AI policy before using any AI platform for these assignments.** It is not my intention to try to stop you from interacting with the future of coding; in fact, I'm hoping to encourage it! **You must, however, report any and all use of AI when working on course assignments.** If I suspect unsanctioned and/or unreported AI use, I reserve the right to hold additional examinations – oral, in-person, or otherwise – to investigate this further. Infractions will result in a zero for the assignment and will be reported.

### **Qualtrics Assignments**

There will be two in-class Qualtrics labs that will help you to learn how to navigate the platform, insert questions, tailor the format of those questions to your research questions, and include data

quality measures, among other things. In class, I will demonstrate how to use Qualtrics in order to be helpful to you in your final project. Again, if you are worried about using a new platform, please rest assured that we will be covering the basics in class, starting at square one. I will also post links to helpful videos. The lab assignments will ask you to generate survey questions solely based on the material we go over in class.

If at any time you are curious about functions of Qualtrics that we do not discuss in class, however, let me know, and I'd be happy to talk you through some of the trickier parts to Qualtrics programming. It is an immensely useful tool but can be more complex for questions that require more intensive programming (none of which will be required in this class).

### **Survey Questions**

On July 8, you will submit your proposed survey questions for your final project as a Word document (from Qualtrics), based on your revised research proposal. *All questions must receive instructor approval before they are distributed to survey subjects.* You will be graded on your initial submissions based on the survey quality measures we discuss in class, and I will provide feedback on your initial submissions quickly. On July 11, you will re-submit your questions, addressing the feedback. To incentivize high-quality survey questions, you will be able to earn half the points missed on your initial submission through your resubmitted questions. For example, if your initial submission receives an 80, and you address all of the feedback given, your re-submission will bring this portion of the grade up to a 90.

### **Final Project**

On July 1, you will submit a brief 2-page, double-spaced research proposal for outlining your final project topic. This proposal should include 1) why this topic is interesting to you and/or its relevance to American politics 2) some background information (in the form of journal articles, news articles, etc.) to build your theory and 3) two or three clearly stated hypotheses, informed by your theory. The proposal should display critical thinking, a general understanding (preliminarily) of the opinion contours regarding your topic, at least five reputable sources (preferably academic journal articles), and adherence to proper grammatical conventions and writing mechanics. On July 8, you will submit a revised research proposal (along with your proposed survey questions) and will receive half the points you missed on the first submission back. **Please meet with me in the first week of classes if you are struggling to come up with a research topic.**

The final project is a research paper 8-10 pages in length, double-spaced, with 12pt Times New Roman font. This is your chance to apply the data skills you have learned throughout the course and synthesize real-world data with substantive research questions. You should include a

brief description of the importance/relevance of your topic, a theory section with at least 10 reputable sources, two or three clearly stated hypotheses, data analyses conducted to evaluate your hypotheses based on your survey data, clear representations of your results, and the conclusions based on your findings. You will also submit a data file in **R** that you use to generate your results, test your hypotheses, and depict graphs and/or tables. I should be able to run your code from top to bottom with no errors. A more detailed list of guidelines and grading will be posted to Canvas.

### **Final Presentation**

Each presentation should last approximately 15 minutes. You should include a short discussion of the relevance of your research questions, the theory and background information relevant to your question and hypotheses, 2-3 clearly stated hypotheses, clear representation of your results, a discussion of your findings, and the conclusions you reached based on your hypotheses and findings. I will post a more in-depth guide to the final presentation on Canvas and discuss this in the classes leading up to the presentation. There are also built-in workshop days, where I will be available for any questions, to facilitate high-quality final projects and presentations. Please email me a copy of your presentation before the final exam period on July 29.

### **Late Work**

Once again, I must stress that this course is a sprint, not a marathon. However, unforeseen daily circumstances and the pace of the course may necessitate that high-quality work cannot be completed by the due date. Trust me, I understand. At the same time, for you (completing assignments) and I (grading assignments) to complete our relevant tasks in a timely manner, the due dates are relatively inflexible.

So, I will allow **one full grace day for all assignments**, excluding in-class quizzes and the final presentation, which must be given during the final exam period. You do not need to provide any justification for using grace days. This should cover nearly all circumstances that should arise, but if there are particularly extenuating circumstances, please reach out to me (days ahead of time, if possible) so that we can make the necessary arrangements. Work submitted more than one full day (24 hours) after the original due date will be considered late and will be penalized by 10 points per day that the work is considered late.

### **AI Policy**

The use of AI is permitted in this class, but **only under certain circumstances**. First, it should be noted that generative AI should not be used, under any circumstance, to generate writing on

your part. This includes, but may not be limited to, the writing of survey questions, the research proposal, the final project, and the final presentation. While AI is useful in many respects, it is still imperative that we learn to communicate our own ideas in writing effectively. Some AI platforms (e.g., Grammarly) that correct grammar are permitted, but *under no circumstances should AI be used to do the writing for you, even if your ideas are being put into AI.*

Coding, on the other hand, is a different question. 5-10 years ago, one of the top majors recommended for undergraduates was computer science due to the promising job prospects and demand for coders. Today, generative AI can do much of this work itself, and the outlook for computer science is beginning to look quite different. I myself use AI from time to time to help with coding. It is more useful, for example, to learn how to correct errors in code by interacting with an AI platform than to spend hours and hours on platforms such as StackExchange to find the correct answer.

Why not use AI to generate code in **R**, then? AI cannot be used as a substitute for learning to code. As you probably know, AI often makes things up and/or produces significant errors. Moreover, it will be difficult to know whether the code that is generated is accurate if you do not know what the arguments are actually doing. You must have an understanding of the coding language to be able to evaluate the effectiveness of AI-generated code.

So, what is the upshot? I expect you all to generate your own code in **R**. The coding assignments walk you through, step-by-step, how to write the code necessary. However, should you run into an error, or have a question about what a line of code is doing, this is when you may ask an AI platform to explain or correct code. **In either case, you must ask it to tell you why your original code is doing what it is doing. In addition, you must submit a copy of your conversation with the AI along with any assignment for which you use it.**

The reason for this is twofold. First, to uphold standards of transparency with AI usage. **Any unsanctioned and/or unreported use of AI will be investigated and reported.** Second, I will be able to give you feedback on the quality of your AI conversation. There are now courses being taught on the effectiveness of interacting with AI, e.g., how to effectively communicate your goals. I am not an expert on this by any means, but I can help give feedback if I notice areas where you might save more time or more effectively communicate questions.

As with all parts of the syllabus, I reserve the right to extend or revise this section of the syllabus as needed. Specific assignments will include additional requirements reporting standards for AI usage as needed.

### **Writing Center**

For free feedback on any course writing projects, check out UNC's Writing Center. Writing Center coaches can assist with any writing project, including multimedia projects and application



essays, at any stage of the writing process. You don't even need a draft to come visit. To schedule a 45-minute appointment, review quick tips, or request written feedback online, visit [UNC's Writing Center online](#).

### **Learning Center**

Want to get the most out of this course or others this semester? Visit [UNC's Learning Center](#) to make an appointment or register for an event. Their free, popular programs will help you optimize your academic performance. Try academic coaching, peer tutoring, STEM support, ADHD/LD services, workshops and study camps, or review tips and tools available on the website.

### **University Attendance Policy**

**University Policy:** As stated in the University's [Class Attendance Policy](#), no right or privilege exists that permits a student to be absent from any class meetings, except for these University Approved Absences:

1. Authorized University activities: [University Approved Absence Office \(UAAO\)](#) website provides information and [FAQs for students](#) and [FAQs for faculty](#) related to University Approved Absences
2. Disability/religious observance/pregnancy/short-term military service, as required by law and approved by the [Equal Opportunity and Compliance Office](#) (EOC), or in the case of short-term military service, the Dean of Students
3. Significant health condition and/or personal/family emergency as approved by the [Office of the Dean of Students](#), [Gender Violence Service Coordinators](#), and/or the [Equal Opportunity and Compliance Office](#) (EOC).

### **Code of Conduct**

1. All students are expected to adhere to University policy and follow the guidelines of the UNC Code of Conduct. Additional information can be found at <https://studentconduct.unc.edu/>.

### **Equal Opportunities and Compliance**

Equal Opportunity and Compliance Accommodations Team ([Accommodations – UNC Equal Opportunity and Compliance](#)) receives requests for accommodations for disability, pregnancy

and related conditions, and sincerely held religious beliefs and practices through the University's Policy on Accommodations. EOC Accommodations team determines eligibility and reasonable accommodations consistent with state and federal laws.

### **Counseling and Psychological Services**

UNC-Chapel Hill is strongly committed to addressing the mental health needs of a diverse student body. The [Heels Care Network](#) website is a place to access the many mental health resources at Carolina. CAPS is the primary mental health provider for students, offering timely access to consultation and connection to clinically appropriate services. Go to the [CAPS website](#) or visit their facilities on the third floor of the Campus Health building for an initial evaluation to learn more. Students can also call CAPS 24/7 at 919-966-3658 for immediate assistance.

### **Title IX Resources**

Any student who is impacted by discrimination, harassment, interpersonal (relationship) violence, sexual violence, sexual exploitation, or stalking is encouraged to seek resources on campus or in the community. Reports can be made [online to the EOC](#) or by contacting the [University's Title IX Coordinator](#), Elizabeth Hall, or the [Report and Response Managers](#) in the Equal Opportunity and Compliance Office. Please note that I am designated as a Responsible Employee, which means I must report to the EOC any information I receive about the forms of misconduct listed in this paragraph. If you'd like to speak with a confidential resource, those include Counseling and Psychological Services, the University's Ombuds Office, and the [Gender Violence Services Coordinators](#). Additional resources are available at [safe.unc.edu](http://safe.unc.edu).

### **Diversity Statement**

I regard diversity as a high ideal to be pursued. As such, this class is an inclusive space for any and all races, gender identities, national origins, ethnicities, religions, social classes, ages, sexual orientations, political backgrounds, ideologies, or physical and learning abilities, among others. Additionally, diversity of thought is essential to the furtherance of knowledge. This diversity flows from each of us, from each of the categories listed above, and from each of our own experiences in life, so this class will highlight diversity where possible to further strengthen the academic experience in the classroom.

## Course Schedule

Below is a schedule for the course with both the topics that will be covered in class as well as the readings that should be done before each day of class. All readings will be posted on Canvas. I reserve the right to make changes to the schedule listed below and to any other part of the syllabus as needed. A relevant key to the right-hand column is listed below as well.

Some of the later weeks are topics that are yet-to-be-determined. Because we live in a democracy, I thought I would let you choose! I will solicit some responses from you all (public opinion!!), and we can decide what additional topics you all would like to cover. On the other hand, the course is not necessarily a pure democracy, so I reserve the right to step in and exert some dictatorial power over these topics.

*\*Readings that are required before class each day are in plain text format.*

*\*\*Assignments are in bold and have an asterisk next to them. Assignments should be completed and turned in by 11:59pm on the date listed.*

*\*\*\*Suggested readings are in italics and are not required, though they may be helpful to understanding course material or introducing related concepts. I will often reference the suggested readings as we discuss the topic for each day, but any material that is necessary for quiz assessments will be mentioned explicitly in class.*

| Date              | Topics                                                    | Readings and Assignments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6/23<br>(Monday)  | Introduction to public opinion concepts, R, and Qualtrics | Syllabus<br><br><b>*Download and install R and RStudio</b><br><b>*Sign up for a Qualtrics account</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 6/24<br>(Tuesday) | Theories of public opinion and democracy                  | Bernard Berelson, "Democratic Theory and Public Opinion"<br>- <i>Read and understand highlighted portions. You may skim the rest.</i><br><br>Christopher Achen and Larry Bartels, <i>Democracy for Realists</i> , Ch. 1<br><br><i>Suggested reading: V.O. Key, Jr., Public Opinion and American Democracy, Ch.1</i> |

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| 6/25<br>(Wednesday) | <p>Foundations of public opinion research</p> <p>Political knowledge and citizen (in)competence</p> <p><b>In-class R lab #1</b></p> | <p>Philip Converse, “The Nature of Belief Systems in Mass Publics” (pages 1-22 and 44-51)</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <i>This article is quite long and very dense. I do not expect you to dissect every word (some political scientists haven’t!), but I do expect you to understand the significance of the top-line arguments and results. This is one of the seminal works in public opinion, and being familiar with it is crucial to understanding public opinion. <u>Moreover, we will use it as a reference throughout the course.</u> To aid in your understanding of this article, <u>I have uploaded my own notes as a study tool. You will not be required to know anything in the article that is not listed in the notes.</u> Please pay particular attention to anything that is bolded.</i></li> </ul> <p><i>Suggested Reading: Charles Taber and Milton Lodge, “Motivated Skepticism in the Evaluation of Political Beliefs”</i></p> |
| 6/26<br>(Thursday)  | <p>How citizens know “What goes with what”</p> <p>Theory of the survey response</p> <p>Survey question framing and design</p>       | <p>John Zaller, <i>The Nature and Origin of Mass Opinion</i>, Ch. 2</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <i>Zaller is at times confusing but readable. Please be familiar with his arguments and results and be ready to discuss. Again, dissecting every word is not necessary – we will discuss this at length in class.</i></li> </ul> <p>Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 2 &amp; 3</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 6/27<br>(Friday)    | <p>Survey question framing and design (cont’d)</p> <p><b>In-class Qualtrics Lab #1</b></p>                                          | <p>Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 2 &amp; 3</p> <p><b>*Intro to R assignment due</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

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| 6/30<br>(Monday)   | <b>In-class R lab #2</b>                                                                                            | <p>Logan Strother, Spencer Piston, Ezra Golberstein, Sarah Gollust, and Daniel Eisenberg, “College roommates have a modest but significant influence on each other’s political ideology”</p> <p><i>Suggested reading: Angela Bos, Jill Greenlee, Mirya Holman, Zoe Oxley, and Celeste Lay, “This One’s for the Boys”</i></p> <p><i>Angus Campbell, Philip Converse, Warren Miller, Donald Stokes, The American Voter, Ch. 2</i></p> <p><b>*Quiz #1</b></p> <p><b>*Qualtrics Lab #1 due</b></p> |
| 7/1<br>(Tuesday)   | Socialization                                                                                                       | <p>Celeste Lay, Mirya Holman, Jill Greenlee, Zoe Oxley, and Angela Bos, “Partisanship on the Playground”</p> <p><i>Suggested Reading: Matthew Tyler and Shanto Iyengar, “Learning to Dislike Your Opponents”</i></p> <p><b>*Research Proposals due</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 7/2<br>(Wednesday) | Personality and Genetics                                                                                            | <p>Jeffrey Mondak and Karen Halperin, “A Framework for the Study of Personality and Political Behaviour”</p> <p><i>Suggested Reading: John Alford, Carolyn Funk, and John Hibbing, “Are Political Orientations Genetically Transmitted?”</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 7/3<br>(Thursday)  | <p>Survey Quality (methodology, sources of error, and in-survey checks)</p> <p><b>In-class Qualtrics Lab #2</b></p> | <p>Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 9</p> <p><b>*R assignment #2 due</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7/4<br>(Friday)    | <b>No class – Holiday</b>                                                                                           | <b>*Eat a hot dog (veggie versions included) and watch some fireworks!!</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

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| 7/7<br>(Monday)    | <b>In-class R Lab #3</b>                       | <p>Donald Kinder and Lynn Sanders, <i>Divided by Color</i>, Ch. 5</p> <p>Pew Research Data: View by clicking <a href="#">here</a></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Required: Click through all of the tabs in the “Table of Contents” section on the right-hand side of the screen.</li> </ul> <p><i>Suggested Reading: Julian Wamble, Chryl Laird, Corrine McConnaughey, and Ismail White, “We Are One”</i></p> <p><b>*Qualtrics Lab #2 due</b></p> |
| 7/8<br>(Tuesday)   | Race, gender, and other group-based identities | <p>Pamela Conover, “The Influence of Group Identifications on Political Perception and Evaluation”</p> <p>Pew Research Data: View by clicking <a href="#">here</a></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <i>Not required: Click through all of the tabs in the “Table of Contents” on the right-hand side to view all results.</i></li> </ul> <p><b>*Revised Research Proposals due</b></p> <p><b>*Survey Questions due</b></p>                           |
| 7/9<br>(Wednesday) | Media and Framing                              | <p>Martin Gilens, “How the Poor Became Black”</p> <p><i>Suggested Reading: Christopher Bail et al., “Exposure to opposing views on social media can increase political polarization”</i></p> <p><i>Brendan Nyhan et al., “Like-minded sources on Facebook are prevalent but not polarizing”</i></p>                                                                                                                                                              |

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| 7/10<br>(Thursday)  | Cognitive Interviewing<br><br>Descriptive statistics<br><br>Hypothesis testing | Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 5 & 6<br><br><b>*Quiz #2</b><br><br><b>*R assignment #3 due</b>                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 7/11<br>(Friday)    | Hypothesis testing (cont'd)<br><br>Confidence intervals                        | Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 6 & 7<br><br><b>*Revised Survey Questions due</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 7/14<br>(Monday)    | <b>In-class R lab #4</b>                                                       | Louis Rea and Richard Parker, Ch. 6 & 7<br><br><b>*Finalize survey questionnaires (in class)</b><br>- <b>Do not begin fielding your survey until you have received final approval from me.</b>                                                                        |
| 7/15<br>(Tuesday)   | "Ideology"<br><br>Partisanship and Polarization                                | Christopher Ellis and James Stimson,<br><i>Ideology in America</i> , Ch. 1<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Pamela Conover and Stanley Feldman, "The Origins and Meaning of Liberal/Conservative Self-Identifications"</i><br><br><b>*Begin fielding Qualtrics survey</b> |
| 7/16<br>(Wednesday) | Partisanship and Polarization (cont'd)                                         | Marc Hetherington, "Resurgent Mass Partisanship"<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Larry Bartels, "Partisanship and Voting Behavior"</i>                                                                                                                                   |
| 7/17<br>(Thursday)  | <b>In-class R lab #5</b>                                                       | Lilliana Mason, <i>Uncivil Agreement</i> , Ch. 5<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Lilliana Mason, "I Disrespectfully Agree"</i><br><br><b>*R assignment #4 due</b>                                                                                                        |
| 7/18<br>(Friday)    | Final project workshop day                                                     | <b>*Quiz #3</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

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| 7/21<br>(Monday)    | Special Topic: Conspiratorial Thinking and Beliefs                                   | Enders et al., “Are Republicans and Conservatives More Likely to Believe Conspiracy Theories?”<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Oliver and Wood, “Conspiracy Theories and the Paranoid Style(s) of Mass Opinion”</i><br><br><i>Miller, “Psychological, Political, and Situational Factors Combine to Boost COVID-19 Conspiracy Theory”</i> |
| 7/22<br>(Tuesday)   | Special Topic: Morality, Moralization, Religion, Religious Nationalism, and Politics | Walker and Haider-Markel, “Fear and Loathing: How Demographic Change Affects Support for Christian Nationalism”<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Delton, DeScioli, and Ryan, “Moral Obstinacy in Political Negotiations”</i><br><br><b>*R assignment #5 due</b>                                                                            |
| 7/23<br>(Wednesday) | Special Topic: Authoritarianism                                                      | Hetherington and Suhay, “Authoritarianism, Threat, and Americans’ Support for the War on Terror”<br><br><i>Suggested Reading: Wronski et al., “A Tale of Two Democrats: How Authoritarianism Divides the Democratic Party”</i><br><br><b>*Deadline for feedback on Rough Draft</b>                                                     |
| 7/24<br>(Thursday)  | Final project workshop day                                                           | <b>*Quiz #4</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 7/25<br>(Friday)    | <b>No class – Reading Day</b>                                                        | <b>*Final papers due on Saturday (7/26)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 7/28<br>(Monday)    | <b>No class – Final Exam Day 1</b>                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 7/29<br>(Tuesday)   | Final Exam Time: 11:30am – 2:30pm. Meet in classroom @11:30am                        | <b>*Final presentations – Email me a copy of your presentation by 11am</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |